

VGA (Video Graphics Array)

The minimum standard for PC video display, which originated with IBM's PS/2 models in 1987.

XGA (Extended Graphics Array)

An IBM video display standard introduced in 1990 that extended VGA to 132-column text and interlaced 1024 x 768 x 256 resolution.

CPUs

Front Side Bus (FSB)

The primary bus interface that connects a microprocessor to other system devices via the Northbridge system chipset. Typically, it allows the processor to communicate with main memory (RAM), the system chipset, PCI devices, the AGP card, and other peripheral buses. It also connects to the Level 2 cache unless the processor has a backside bus.

L1 Cache

A small amount of SRAM memory integrated or packaged within the same module as the processor. It's clocked at the same speed of the processor. L1 cache is used to temporarily store instructions and data, making sure the processor has a steady supply of data to process while the memory catches up with the delivering of new data.

L2 Cache

Typically consists of SRAM chips near the processor, although the latest Athlon processors have on-chip L2 caches. This is cache used to temporarily store instructions and data to ensure the processor has a steady supply of data to process until main memory catches up. Also known as the secondary cache, this is the second-fastest memory available to a microprocessor, second only to the L1 cache.